

Height. Do tall patterns perform better than short ones? Yes. The widest difference is in bull markets where price drops 19% for tall patterns but just 13% for short ones. I measured height from the highest high to the lowest low in the pattern (starting from the left shoulder peak to the right shoulder peak) and then divided by the breakout price. Those patterns with values higher than the median shown in the table were tall.

Width. Width is less reliable as a performance indicator than height. I used the median time from shoulder to shoulder to gauge width. As the table shows, there's no consistent trend from bull to bear markets (wide works best in bull markets, but narrow patterns outperform in bear markets).

Height and width combinations. The results say that tall patterns outperform. Avoid short ones.

[Table 41.6](#) shows volume-related statistics.

Volume trend, breakout performance. Volume trends downward between the two shoulders most of the time, but if you see a head-and-shoulders with an upward volume trend, it's fine. As the performance statistics show, volume has little to do with performance.

Table 41.7 is not shown because the nature of the pattern doesn't lend itself to finding stop locations automatically.

[Table 41.8](#) shows the performance over three decades